



◁ Arado Ar234B-2 1944

Origin Germany

Engine 2 x 1,103 lb (500 kg) thrust
Junkers Jumo 004B-1 turbojets

Top speed 461 mph (742 km/h)

The Ar234 was the world's first jet bomber. Designed for long-range reconnaissance, it was so fast that few Allied aircraft could catch it. Initially it had a dolly and skid type undercarriage (to save weight). This proved impractical in service and most were fitted with wheels.

▷ Lockheed P-80A Shooting Star 1944

Origin USA

Engine 4,600 lb (2,087 kg) thrust
Allison J33-9 turbojet

Top speed 558 mph (898 km/h)

The Shooting Star was America's first operational American jet fighter, and, although it arrived in Europe too late to see action during WWII, it was used extensively in Korea as the F-80. It quickly became obsolete as a fighter, but evolved into the T-33 jet trainer, which remained in service with both the US Air Force and Navy until the 1970s.



△ Republic F-84C Thunderjet 1946

Origin USA

Engine 5,560 lb (2,522 kg) thrust
Allison J-35 turbojet

Top speed 622 mph (1,000 km/h)

Republic's first jet fighter, this aircraft was intended as a jet-powered replacement for their P-47 Thunderbolt. After a long and troubled gestation period, it evolved into a highly capable fighter-bomber that saw extensive service in the Korean War. The Thunderjet was also the first aircraft flown by the USAF aerobatic team, the Thunderbirds.



◁ Grumman F9F-2 Panther 1947

Origin USA

Engine 5,000 lb (2,268 kg) thrust Pratt & Whitney J42-2 turbojet

Top speed 575 mph (926 km/h)

Grumman's first jet fighter, the Panther, was one of the first jets operated by the US Navy and to see combat in Korea. It was also the first navy jet to score a "kill" during this conflict. The straight-wing Panther was deemed inferior to the sweptwing MiG-15, and a sweptwing version called the Cougar was built later.



▷ McDonnell F2H-2 Banshee 1947

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 3,250 lb (1,474 kg) thrust
Westinghouse J-34 turbojets

Top speed 580 mph (933 km/h)

Derived from the woefully underpowered FH-1 Phantom, the Banshee was fitted with much more powerful engines and soon became an effective fighter-bomber. It also had excellent performance at high altitude, and was often used for photo-reconnaissance. It was the only jet fighter operated by the Royal Canadian Navy.

